

```
qemu-kvm -hda ./windows.hdd -cdrom /home/digit/ISOs/Windows.
iso -boot d -m 256 -localtime
```

The various parameters we passed to `qemu-kvm` are:

- ▶ **-hda ./windows.hdd:** Use the `windows.hdd` file in current directory as the first hard disk. You can use whatever filename you gave to the virtual hard disk file you created. Absolute pathnames will also work.
- ▶ **-cdrom /home/digit/ISOs/Windows.iso:** Use file `/home/digit/ISOs/Windows.iso` as the CD/DVD device. You can use the device name of the physical DVD/CD drive as well (usually `/dev/cdrom` would do it if you have only one optical drive).
- ▶ **-boot d:** Boot using the CD drive allocated.
- ▶ **-m 256:** Provide 256 MB of RAM to the virtual machine.
- ▶ **-localtime:** Use the current time of the machine into the virtual machine. When you don't provide this option, time inside the virtual machine can be several hours ahead or behind the current time.

When you pass the above command, you'll see a new window come up which starts the install procedure from the CD image you pointed Qemu to. It will automatically reboot the virtual machine during the installation. All this time the terminal you issue the command from should remain open. If you close the terminal, the Qemu window will instantly close itself. To avoid this behavior, append the "&" character at the end of the command. The command won't become:

```
qemu-kvm -hda ./windows.hdd -cdrom /home/digit/ISOs/Windows.
iso -boot d -m 256 -localtime &
```

Let the installation complete. Then you can use the following command to boot into the virtual machine:

```
qemu-kvm -hda ./windows.hdd -cdrom /home/digit/ISOs/Windows.
iso -boot c -m 256 -localtime &
```

The only thing you need to change in the command is the boot parameter. We change the boot parameter from `-boot d` to `-boot c`. This asks Qemu to use the hard disk for booting. You can use this command from now on to boot into your Qemu virtual machine anytime you want!

It's clearly evident that running Qemu isn't going to be a piece of cake. There are a lot of troubles before everything starts running. But if you were lucky and `virt-manager` got installed, we recommend using it to your benefit. You would find it in the "System Tools" menu under Gnome.